Mobitel (Pvt.) Ltd.
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POLICY ON FOREIGN TRAVEL

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Contents

1. Purpose 3
2. Scope 3
3. Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee 3
4. Approval Process for Foreign Travel 4
5. Travel on Contracted or Purchase Order based Project Trainings 5
6 Foreign Travel Related Expenses 6
7 Medical cover for official trips abroad 7
8 Submission of Knowledge Sharing Report (KSR) upon return from official trips abroad 7
Document Control Sheet 10
Annexures 11
Related Policies 11

1. Purpose

This document outlines the procedure for foreign travel for Mobitel staff members arising from business or operational requirements such as overseas training, conferences, seminars, workshops, vendor invitations or business trips on behalf of the company.

2. Scope

This policy covers foreign travel of Mobitel staff members who are on confirmed status, on contract or permanent basis at all levels with the recommendation of their respective Line Manager/Functional Heads/HOD. Foreign travel recommendation for Chairman & Board of Directors should be with the approval of the Board, where such extract should be shared with the Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee (FTEC).

3. Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee

The Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee (FTEC) is formed for the purpose of performing an independent and transparent evaluation on the scope of the foreign travel request.

The Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee (FTEC) makes recommendations including CEO/COO's approval within 3 working days from date of receiving the duly completed travel request with relevant supporting documents.

FTEC recommendations with 2/3 majority is acceptable to proceed for CEO/COO's approval

3.1. FTEC will evaluate the eligibility of the nominee(s) by considering the following but not limited to:

- Validity of the business justification should also include for selecting of Nominees
  Note: Respective HODs/ functional heads are responsible on providing accurate justification for nominees in their divisions.
- Estimated travel cost
- Employment status
- Previous travel history
- Pending training bonds and knowledge sharing report (KSR)
- Retirement date
- Resignation notification
- Subject to disciplinary process at the time of foreign travel request
- Identified foreign training gaps on business exigencies and provide recommendation in as appropriate. (Annexure 1-Part A)

3.2. All the foreign travel requests must be submitted to the Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee by the respective line managers/functional heads/HOD's. The Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee will consist of the below designated personnel.

- Chief Officer-SCM/ Member of SMT nominated by COO
- Head of HR - Mobitel
- Head of Internal Control – Mobitel

The COO/CEO reserves the right to appoint or change the members of the Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee on an annual basis.

4. Approval Process for Foreign Travel

4.1 All foreign travel requests must be directly submitted to the HR Division in order to facilitate the foreign travel.

4.2 Foreign travel shall be identified by the respective Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD and included in the respective annual divisional foreign travel budget at the point of preparing the Annual Business Plan. In the event of any ad-hoc foreign travel requirement for business reasons, such requests should also be channeled through the FTEC & COO/CEO.

4.3 The following components to be considered when budgeting the requested foreign travel and an estimated cost should be calculated by the Travel Unit of Administration division and submitted to the HR division. If the cost for the foreign travel is borne by an external party that shall be communicated by the respective Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD through a memorandum which shall be considered when calculating the cost.

- Programme cost
- Air Ticket
- Visa
- Insurance
- Accommodation
- Per-diem
- Airport transfers
- Any other miscellaneous expenses (such as, early check in, late check out, taxi fee, laundry and incidental expenses.)

Further, at the point of calculating the estimated cost the travel unit shall consider the supporting documents such as program brochure, sponsorship letter, PO (if applicable), flight itinerary and any other relevant documentation and forward same to the HR division.

4.4 Once all documents are duly completed and reviewed by the HR Division, the full set shall be submitted to the Foreign Travel Evaluation Committee (FTEC) for evaluation and making recommendations.

4.5 The FTEC evaluates the foreign travel request and along with their recommendations, shall be forwarded for COO/CEO's review and approval and only upon receiving the approval of COO/CEO, travel arrangements are proceeded.

4.6 In the event that the Chief Operating Officer (COO) / Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of Mobitel is nominated or required to travel abroad for official business purposes, such travel

shall be subject to the approval of the Group CEO of SLT-Mobitel. In the absence of the Group CEO, the required approval shall be obtained from the Interim CEO.

4.7 If the entire foreign travel request or nominee/s for the travel is rejected by FTEC, the Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD has an option to appeal to the FTEC for re-evaluation with a valid justification.

4.8 In the event if the COO/CEO has any concerns over the recommendation made by the FTEC, COO/CEO reserves the right to forward such concerns to FTEC for further review.

4.9 In the event that the foreign travel is approved by the COO/CEO, the HR Division shall notify the relevant Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD of the approval. Furthermore, the HR division shall inform the Travel Unit to proceed with the necessary travel arrangements.

4.10 The Travel Unit shall notify the relevant employee(s) via email to submit the duly completed Overseas Travel Request Form (OTRF) (Annexure 2), along with the required travel documents.

4.11 The HR Division then proceeds with the obtaining of the duly signed Service Bond, where applicable. Upon submission of all required documents, the Travel Unit proceeds with finalizing the travel arrangements including air ticket, VISA, accommodation, transfers, insurance, registration confirmation where applicable.

4.12 The Travel Unit maintains and upload the OTRF along with the actual utilization of foreign travel budgets and HR division uploads the duly signed service bonds to the respective folders in the one drive where editing and viewing facility is assigned to the relevant Administration and Human Resources team members.

4.13 Human Resources division maintains staff training records as well as scope covered by such travel based on approximate cost provided by Travel Unit.

5. Travel on Contracted or Purchase Order based Project Trainings

5.1 Project owner needs to submit to FTEC the following documents to proceed with seeking budgetary approval.

- Copy of relevant PO and Invitation letter
- If PO is not issued, a copy of the related page in contract relating to training with covering memo from HOD and Invitation letter
- Individual Development Plan (IDP) if Training Gap is not identified in Training Needs Analysis (TNA). (Annexure 4)
- Overseas Travel request and evaluation memo
- Overseas Travel Request Form (OTRF)

5.2 The project owner shall inform the participants of the estimated bond value and forward duly authorized service bond to HR division with copies to Administration division.

5.3 The standard review and approval process should be followed in facilitating the foreign travel.

6 Foreign Travel Related Expenses

This includes expenses such as air ticket, accommodation, insurance, registration, per-diem and any miscellaneous expenditure related to overseas travel.

Administration division shall perform standard PR/PO process for all the expenditures related to overseas travel. Considering the urgency and time limitations some expenditures may process as advance payments, but all such advance payments need to be settled through a standard PO within a period of 02months from arrival in order to capture all the costs related to the foreign travel.

6.1 Air Travel

All staff will travel on Economy Class. Exception to be allowed only by considering the urgency of the foreign travel and the reservation options available with the carrier.

Chairman & Board of Directors shall travel Business Class, and staff at Chief/SGM/GM levels are allowed to travel Business Class for travel over four hours and above.

6.2 Hotel Accommodation

In the event of the Company or Vendor sponsoring staff for overseas travel, suitable accommodation need to be provided as appropriate. Accommodation to be booked on bed and breakfast basis for all levels. If the booking is excluding breakfast the participant is permitted to claim reasonable actual cost for breakfast with original receipts upon return through the Travel Unit of the Administration Division.

6.3 Incidental Expenses

All official expenses related to the foreign travel such as cost of phone calls, taxi fare, transit visas and extra sector fares if any, additional extended accommodation and meals due to flight schedules and any other miscellaneous cost involved which is related to official travel will be reimbursed in full for the actual cost, provided that same is supported by original receipts. Original documents of bills/ receipts should be forwarded in support of expenses at the time of settlement of the cash advances if taken through the Travel Unit of the Administration Division.

6.4 Roaming Facility

Employees traveling on official foreign travel are required to activate an appropriate and cost-effective roaming package.
Reimbursement for call charges related to official communication will be processed subject to the approval of the respective Line Manager/ Functional Head/ HOD.

6.5 Per-diem entitlement

For foreign travel purposes staff members, Chairman and Board Directors are entitled to a per-diem for official period of stay. Applicable daily rates are as follows. The conversion is done based on the USD to LKR selling rate published by the Central Bank of Sri Lanka (CBSL).

Category	Amount (USD)
CEO/COO	300
Chief Officers	250
Deputy Chief Officers/Senior General Managers	150
General Managers M1 – Head M2/ Senior Manager M2	125
Manager M3/ M3A – Executive E5	100

Note: Above rates are subjected to change with the approval of COO/ CEO.

7 Medical cover for official trips abroad

Medical expenses while abroad are covered by a business travel insurance policy arranged locally through Mobitel. The participant is required to inform the Administration Division three days prior to departure stating the period of intended stay abroad and the travel dates in order to activate the policy.

8 Submission of Knowledge Sharing Report (KSR) upon return from official trips abroad

- Upon successful completion of foreign travel excluding business visits, the participant is required to submit a 'KSR' in connection to the program attended, outlining the purpose, exposure gained, knowledge and skills acquired and any additional information, completed along with any reference material (if available) through the approval of the Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD as per the guideline indicated in Annexure 5 to HRD within two weeks from the date of arrival in Sri Lanka. The submitted document will be uploaded to the intranet training portal by HRD.
- If content of KSR is confidential in nature, same to be notified Human Resources Division via the Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD upon return from the training after sharing the completed KSR with the Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD.
- Failure to submit the Knowledge Sharing Report (KSR), will result in the participant's request for future foreign travel being declined.
- Further any of the following forms/methods of knowledge sharing may be undertaken to disseminate the knowledge acquired.

8.1. Transfer of Learning

This method is used when the Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD is in the view that it is appropriate or necessary if the knowledge acquired at the training by the participant is important and related to all other staff members. Accordingly, the Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD would inform the participant to train respective peers within a month after returning from the foreign training program. The assistance of the HR Division may be sought to coordinate the logistical arrangements for the session subject to the budget availability. Further, the training conducted would be considered as an internal training under the Training Policy where the training hours will be considered into the Company's training hours and will be

recorded in the individual training records of the participants.

8.2. The Senior Management Team (SMT)

Upon request participants are required to share knowledge acquired at an SMT forum as there may be strategic/ sensitive information to be discussed and presented.

9. General

9.1. Any foreign travel partly or fully sponsored by a third party shall be governed by the Staff Sponsorship Policy. (Annexure 3)

9.2. In the event a Mobitel permanent staff member is seconded to SLT or a subsidiary of Mobitel the foreign travel costs related to such employee(s) need to be borne by SLT or subsidiary company provided that the requirement is from the seconded company. However, if such employee(s) is required to attend a foreign travel at the request of Mobitel, the cost of such travel shall be borne by Mobitel subject to the evaluation and recommendation of the FTEC & the approval of COO/CEO.

9.3. Age limit of nominees for foreign trainings shall be 55 years or less. If the nominee is above specified age the staff member is not eligible for foreign training. However, this condition is not applicable for conferences, workshops, seminars, and business trips upon the evaluation and recommendation of the FTEC & the approval of COO/CEO.

9.4. If a staff member is invited to participate as a resource person or panelist by an external organization, training institution, or conference, the travel request must be approved by the relevant Head of Department (HOD). The approval should be granted only after ensuring that the staff member's absence will not adversely affect or disrupt ongoing business operations or activities. The Management reserves the right to approve or deny such requests at its discretion.

9.5. In the event that a staff member is invited to participate as a resource person by a foreign organization or training institution, the Company covers the associated travel costs only once per calendar year, provided that a portion of these expenses is covered by the inviting organization or institution. Staff members participating as resource persons/panelist for any form of trainings/ conference, need to be complied by the Company's Information Security Policy.

9.6. In order for an employee to be nominated for a Foreign Training program, the staff member should be in confirmed status. In case of any exception Line Manager/Functional Head/HOD is requested to provide strong business justification/recommendation for inclusion subject to the evaluation and recommendation of the FTEC & the approval of COO/CEO.

9.7. If an employee is subject to a disciplinary process, such employee(s) are not eligible to be nominated for foreign travel during that period. Further if an employee is found guilty of an act of indiscipline/misconduct, such employee is not eligible for any foreign travel for a period of 6 months from the date of execution of the disciplinary measure.

9.8. If the nominee(s) has any unexpired bonds such details need to be notified to the FTEC by HRD. Further, the nominee has to submit any pending Knowledge Sharing Reports (KSR) from previous foreign travel to HRD prior to commencing the process of the new foreign travel.

9.9. It is compulsory for the nominees to sign the service bond to be eligible for the foreign travel, when applicable, please refer HR 0033 Bonding Policy for Mobitel staff.

9.10. Leave for personal foreign travel must be planned in advance to avoid official functions. Overlapping leave for foreign travel of key and senior personnel should be pre-planned to minimize the disruption to the Company.

9.11. Upon completing all travel related activities, Administration division is handing over all relevant documents but not limited to travel documents, hotel reservations, per diem, insurance, registration, immigration cards to the respective nominee along with the checklist for handing over of overseas travel Request Form (Annexure 2) signed by Administration Division with any special instructions.

9.12. Upon handing over the documents, Administration division has to inform HR division and shall amend the finalized service bond value in the shared folders specified under clause 4.11.

Document Control Sheet

Document Versions

Version	Date	Remarks
HR 0028	22nd May 2013	Created new policy by amalgamating policy No. 0006 on submission of reports upon return from official trips abroad dated 09th April, 1999 and Policy No.0012 on Foreign travel expenses dated 01st November, 2001.
HR 0028.1	O1st February 2017	Revision with revised per-diem entitlements and approval process and Amalgamation of Policy on Foreign Travel - Addendum **(HR** 028A).
HR 0028.2	01st January 2024	Revision of Policy with amendments.
HR 0028.3	15th July 2025	Revision of Policy with amendments.

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Annexures

1. Overseas Travel request and evaluation memo
    a. Part B
2. Overseas Travel Request Form
3. HR 034 Sponsorship Policy
4. Individual Development Plan
5. Guideline for knowledge sharing report

Related Policies

Please refer following Policies for further details in connection with this Policy on Foreign Travel.

HR 0003 - Policy on Training and Development

HR 0011 - Policy on Leave Entitlement

HR 0033 - Bonding Policy for Mobitel Staff

HR 0034 - Staff Sponsorship Policy